tragic showdown between an immigrant and an ethnic Dutchman. He was critical of Dutch tolerance of immigrants: ‘The tolerance of other cultures, often barely understood, that spread with new waves of migration, was sometimes just that – tolerance – and sometimes sheer indifference, bred by a lack of confidence in values and institutions that needed to be defended.’[114] Buruma described Dutch society at the time as ‘post-multi-cult confusion’ associated with Dutch feelings of guilt from World War II (some believe that the Netherlands did not do enough at the time to defend its Jews) and the negative attitudes towards Moroccan and Turkish guest workers. He sums up the words of Muhammad, the later murderer of Theo van Gogh, that ‘Holland would be the cradle of a religious revolution, made possible by precisely those political liberties that Mohammad affected to despise.’[115]

Among the thinkers mentioned by Buruma in his book is the Dutch sociologist Paul Scheffer, who in 2007 published the influential book *Immigrant Nations*. It analyses in detail the phenomenon of immigration from other cultures, both from the point of view of immigrants and native residents. His central idea is that both groups need to be subjected to critical reflection. Scheffer advocates a new definition of citizenship based on history and culture, taking into account the contribution of immigrants: ‘Citizenship is all about a consciousness that something came before us and something will come after us.’[116] He calls for the introduction of citizenship rituals, for more attention in the school system to history and law, and for a canon of national history. In the process of integration, the immigrant must, in his view, acquire a range of knowledge and skills. Above all, integration is about ‘the willingness to be part of society’, and this inevitably means re-evaluating the tradition brought from elsewhere, says Scheffer. At the same time, integration requires an environment in which migrants and their children feel invited to participate in society. He concludes that multiculturalism was naive and wrong: ‘Multiculturalism offered an answer that contained no obligation when it said that it has become meaningless to talk about “us” because society is a collection of subcultures … A new “we” is needed.’[117] And further: ‘Without “us”, without an imagined community, there will be no shared responsibility for the changing destiny of society.’[118] He stresses that the nation state is still an important institution for the identification of individuals, even if citizenship of the European Union